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November 17, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
University of Virginia
Charlottesville, VA 22904
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the tenure-track Assistant Professor position in the Department of Economics at the University of Virginia, beginning August 10, 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to examine the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

The Department of Economics at the University of Virginia is renowned for its strength in macroeconomics, econometrics, and applied microeconomic research, and for its highly collaborative intellectual culture. My research and methods align closely with this environment: I build structural and quantitative models grounded in micro data and link them to questions of aggregate behavior and policy. I see strong synergies with UVA faculty working on macroeconomics, public finance, and inequality, and I would welcome collaboration through research groups such as the Quantitative Theory Group and the Population Studies Center. I am also eager to contribute to the department's graduate training mission and interdisciplinary initiatives across the College of Arts and Sciences.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students

“convince themselves” that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At UVA, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and *Quantitative Methods for Economics*. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate effectively with faculty and graduate students in a dynamic, research-intensive environment. I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to UVA’s tradition of rigorous research, strong teaching, and collegial engagement within and beyond the department.

I would be honored to join the University of Virginia’s Department of Economics and to contribute to its teaching, research, and mentorship missions. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with the department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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